THE ANCESTRAL DEED

CULTURALLY ADAPTED SCREENPLAY

Culture: Majhi (Central Punjab) | Dialect: Majhi Punjabi

Setting: RURAL (Border Farmsteads) | Script: ROMANIZED (PHONETIC)

Adapted by Cultural Screenplay & Visual Adaptation Studio

Canonical Entity Tracking & Deterministic Continuity Verified

SCENE 1: EXT. HOMESTEAD COURTYARD - EARLY MORNING

[Dramatic Purpose: Amar receives the eviction notice and conceals it from his mother]

[Atmosphere: Heavy winter mist (kohrra), smell of dung smoke and damp winter mustard]

A heavy winter mist (kohrra) hangs low over the brick haveli courtyard. AMARJIT SINGH (32), shoulders hunched in an unbleached khadi khes, laces his worn work boots on a woven charpai. A bicycle bell rings. RAM LAL THE DAK-WALA enters, shivering in a khaki coat.

DAK-WALA

"Late Harjit Singh ji de parwaar layi sarkari kissa hai. Dastkhat chahide ne."

[Tone: Routine Bureaucracy]

AMAR

(hushed, chest tightening)

"Aithe fada, chacha. Roula na pa, Bebe andar haje jaagdi payi ae."

[Tone: Stifled Urgency]

DAK-WALA

"Lao ji. Rabb mehr kare."

[Tone: Familiar Rural Compassion]

SCENE 2: INT. FAMILY HEARTH & KITCHEN - AFTERNOON

[Dramatic Purpose: Kabir demands liquidation of ancestral acreage for city visa; Bebe defends soil]

[Atmosphere: Sunlight piercing woodsmoke in soot-stained brick rasoi, bubbling lentils]

Sunlight cuts through pungent kikar smoke in the kitchen hearth. GURMEET KAUR (BEBE, 62) stirs yellow lentils in a black iron handi. KABIR SINGH (24), wearing an imported leather jacket and sneakers, paces impatiently. Amar enters carrying firewood, keeping the debt letter hidden in his inner vest.

KABIR

(scoffing, checking watch)

"Bada chira layata, Bhaji! Pind de aade to shehar wali bus panj vaje nikal jaani ae!"

[Tone: Impatient Modern Disdain]

AMAR

(quietly unloading firewood)

"Khala saaf karan vich tin ghante lag gaye, chotay. Pehla kadi roti kha lae sukoon naal."

[Tone: Suppressed Agony]

KABIR

(flaring)

"Main shehar ton daal roti khaan nahi aaya! Agent nu kal dupehar tak do kille di registry chahidi ae. Je zameen vechage, taan hi Canada di file agge turugi!"

[Tone: Entitled Defiance]

BEBE

(firm, ladle frozen in hand)

"Aah charda killa tere Daada ji ne khun paseena baha ke kaddya si! Eh mitti nahi vikugi, Kabir!"

[Tone: Maternal Sacred Authority]

SCENE 3: EXT. THE DRY CANAL & ANCESTRAL GROVE - SUNSET

[Dramatic Purpose: Amar reveals the 34 Lakh medical debt notice; Kabir renounces departure]

[Atmosphere: Saffron and violet dusk, cold wind rustling dry eucalyptus leaves]

The dry canal bed is flanked by ancient eucalyptus trees. Kabir walks briskly with his duffel bag. Amar intercepts him on the dirt road, chest heaving. He pulls the crumpled debt notice from his vest and thrusts it into Kabir's chest.

AMAR

(trembling with grief)

"Parh lai ehnu! Te fer vech de aah zameen! Chauthi vaar aayi ae kachehri di chitthi! Chatti lakh rupaye karza chadiya si Bapu de ilaaj te!"

[Tone: Cathartic Devastation]

KABIR

(reading seal, eyes widening in horror)

"Eh... eh karza? Bhaji... tussi kadi dassya kyu nahi?"

[Tone: Humbling Remorse]

AMAR

(tears in eyes)

"Kive kehnda tainu? Tainu parhana si, kabile kabil banana si... Main zameen da tukda nahi, apna dil sambhalda reha."

[Tone: Unconditional Fraternal Love]

KABIR

(dropping duffel, embracing Amar)

"Main nahi jaanda, Bhaji. Kal savere aapan dovey rall ke tractor jodage."

[Tone: Reclaimed Loyalty]